

■ resolve~tips & tricks

the drop-down menu, and select Restricted Sites. For changing the Zone in Outlook Express, go to Tools > Options > Security, and select the Restricted Sites option.

 Hiding IP address in ICQ

Since ICQ works by establishing a direct connection, you should ensure that your IP address is not visible to other users. Select the option to hide your IP address (though a determined user can easily bypass this security option), and ensure that other users need authorisation before they can connect to you. You can even select to remain invisible to most users and not publicise your details on the Web.

 Spoofing IP in mIRC

When you are chatting in an IRC channel, anyone can just give the command /whois <yournickname> to get your IP address.

To spoof your IP address, you can use the command, /mode <yournick> +x (or +z) depending on the channel. Alternatively, you can work through a proxy server or an anonymiser.

 Using a proxy server

The best possible solution for absolute privacy is to surf using a proxy server. You could, for instance, use Internet Junkbuster Proxy (www.junkbusters.com/ht/en/ijb.html), which can selectively block

cookies. Another such tool is InterMute (www.intermute.com/), which blocks pop-ups as well.

 Keeping a spam address

When filling up registration forms at sites or when you have to provide your e-mail address at public places, you should use an e-mail address that you have specially created for that purpose and don't give out your personal e-mail address.

Also, see to it that you reveal the bare minimum in the forms, and give false information as far as possible (unless you are in a shopping site, and require delivery of a product).

PC SECURITY

You can secure your PC by using firewalls and antivirus programs and configuring them correctly. A few tips towards this end

 Locking Internet access in ZoneAlarm

If your office has an always-on Internet connection, use ZoneAlarm's Internet Lock feature to protect your machine in your absence. To enable this, right-click on the ZoneAlarm icon in the system tray and choose 'Restore

Next, check the High Security option. This will stop all Internet activity if the machine remains idle for more than 20 minutes.

 E-mail protection with Norton Antivirus

If you are using an e-mail client to access your POP mail account(s), then you could set up Norton AntiVirus to scan all incoming mail. To do this, start Norton AntiVirus and open the Options window. In the left pane, browse down to the E-Mail Protection sub-menu under the Internet menu.

Next, select the e-mail accounts you want scanned before the mail is downloaded on to your hard disk. Finally, from the Action tab, specify the action to be taken in case a mail is infected by a virus and press OK to complete the configuration.

If you have Norton Personal Firewall, then you can also block ActiveX controls and other cookies. A unique feature of Norton is that it can also block advertisements and HTTP referrers (wherein a site comes to know where you are coming from).

 Importance of LiveUpdates

By default, LiveUpdate is configured to look for updates every time you connect to the Internet irrespective of whether or not updates have been released. This can be very annoying. You can change the default setting to download updates only when a newer version is available. To do this, browse to the LiveUpdate menu under Internet in the Norton AntiVirus Options dialog box. By default, the 'Apply updates without interrupting me' option is checked. Change the default option by ticking the check box against 'Notify me when updates are available' and press OK.

 Scanning all downloads in FlashGet

You can set up your download manager to scan files before they are downloaded. To configure FlashGet, start FlashGet and open the Options window from the Tools Menu. Once there, click on the File Manager tab and tick the check box against the 'Use virus scanner to scan the downloaded files' and browse to the folder where your antivirus program is stored.



Use the Lock icon to block Internet access

ZoneAlarm Control Centre'. Then click on the Lock tab. The Internet Lock is disabled by default. Click on Enable. Now specify a delay time of 20 minutes.

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